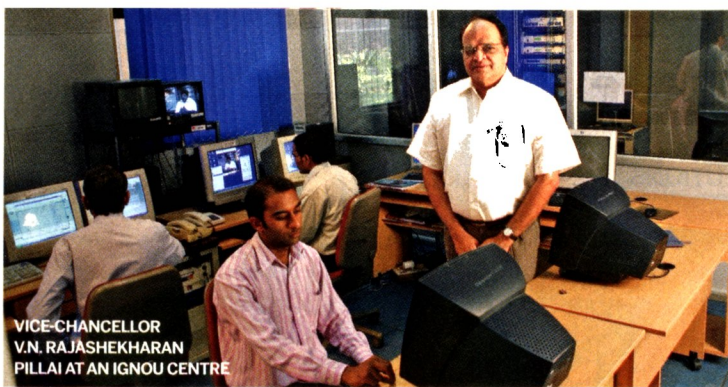




INDIRA GANDHI NATIONAL OPEN UNIVERSITY Delhi **PUSHING THE FRONTIERS**

Established by an Act of Parliament in 1985, the Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU), that boasts of 300 new study centres and a 1.8-million strong student force, has played a pivotal role in the qualitative and quantitative expansion of higher education ever since its inception in India. And now with the help of EDUSAT (a satellite dedicated to

education) and the Inter-University Consortium, an interactive project, the university has linked its several regional and international study centres, like the one in Africa, through 134 video conferencing centres. "From journalism to community colleges, IGNOU has collaborated with a wide range of institutions of repute to meet the needs of students and give greater access to a large number of people," says Vice-Chancellor V.N. Rajashekharan Pillai.

by Gunjeet Sra

IGNOU offers **175** professional and vocational programmes.

has grown into the world's largest mobile education system with Mobile Labs revolutionising learning in rural India by encouraging children to observe and impart knowledge to others as well. An initiative of Agastya Foundation, headed by Ramji Raghavan, 53, this dissemination model has fascinated many, including the MIT's media lab and the Clinton Global Initiative. Raghavan worked with numerous investment banks in the US and UK

before he came back to India. He then paired with his Rishi Valley School Principal, S. Balasundram, and F. Mahaveer Kumar, the then president of Bangalore Stock Exchange, and embarked on the project. Raghavan believes if he has a science centre in each district, he can reach children within a 30-40 km radius. If each centre has about four or five vans, every district will be covered. "If we do this, Indian children will super charge to the future," he says.

by Swagata Sen



Luxor

Helping today's India learn.

PARKER | WATERMAN
PARIS
PILOT | Luxor®
CONVERGE

Luxor® SIGNATURE

Buy online at www.luxor.in